

23 Asking polite questions

In English, asking questions directly can sometimes be seen as impolite. It is very common for English speakers to make their questions more indirect.

⚙️ **New language** Direct and indirect questions

Aa **Vocabulary** Job interviews

🧩 **New skill** Asking questions politely

23.1 KEY LANGUAGE POLITE OPEN QUESTIONS

If an indirect question contains "to be," this verb comes after the subject.

What **are** your career goals?



Could **you tell me** what your career goals **are**?

Polite questions usually start with one of these phrases.

The auxiliary verb "to have" also comes after the subject in indirect questions.

What **have** you designed before?



I **was wondering** what you **have** designed before.

The auxiliary verb "to do" does not appear in indirect questions.

Why **do** you enjoy working in fashion?



I'd **like to know** why you enjoy working in fashion.



23.2 REWRITE THE DIRECT QUESTIONS AS INDIRECT QUESTIONS

What are your strengths?

== Could you tell me what your strengths are?

① When are you available?

== I was wondering _____

② Why have you applied for this job?

== I'd like to know _____

③ What is our best-selling product?

== Do you have any idea _____

④ Who was your last manager?

== I'm curious to know _____

